

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION - September 16, 2026

9:00 a.m. - Anne G. Basker Auditorium

600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron Smith, Chair-Commissioner; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner; Gary Richardson, Commissioner; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

- 1. CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m.
- 2. DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:** Commissioners Richardson, Martin, and Smith each declared no potential conflicts of interest.
- 3. PROCLAMATION:**

- a. In the Matter of Proclaiming the Week of September 14-19, 2026, as U.S. Constitution Week**
Commissioner Martin read the proclamation recognizing U.S. Constitution Week and highlighted the Constitution's protections of liberty, justice, and civil and religious rights; the signing of the Constitution on September 17, 1787; the establishment of Constitution Week; and Constitution Day and Citizenship Day. Commissioner Martin thanked the visiting representatives for providing copies of the Constitution and for supporting a Constitution essay scholarship opportunity for local high school students. Chair Smith also thanked the group for bringing the recognition before the Board.

- 4. PUBLIC HEARING: In the Matter of Annexations to the Josephine Community Library District by Petition of Landowner without Election**

Chair Smith opened the public hearing at 9:04 a.m.

The Board considered two petitions for annexation to the Josephine Community Library District. Chair Smith invited public testimony on the annexations. No public testimony was offered.

- a. Board Order No. 2026-041 - TERESA LOUISE RIEGNER LIVING TRUST - Assessor Map/Tax Lot 40-08-02-00-002600-00 - 5.05 acres**

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-041, annexing the property of the Teresa Louise Riegner Living Trust to the Josephine Community Library District. Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

- b. Board Order No. 2026-042 - SAMANTHA WEST GRUYS - Assessor Map/Tax Lot 39-08-36-A0-002800-00 - 4.25 acres**

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-042, annexing the property of Samantha West Gruys to the Josephine Community Library District. Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Chair Smith closed the public hearing at 9:05 a.m.

- 5. PUBLIC HEARING: Board Order No. 2026-051; In the Matter of Uniform Procedure for Setting Fees Charged by County: District Attorney, Various Fee**

Chair Smith opened the public hearing at 9:06 a.m.

Chair Smith invited public testimony. No public testimony was offered. During Board discussion, the Commissioners noted that the District Attorney fees had not been adjusted for nearly ten years and described the proposed changes as bringing the fees closer to the County's current cost of providing the services rather than generating a profit.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-051 regarding the District Attorney's various fees. Seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Chair Smith closed the public hearing at 9:07 a.m.

6. REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS: *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*

Mr. Fitch, a returning resident, spoke regarding a public records request for video related to an incident in an elevator. He stated the request had been pending for many months, that he had appealed the matter to the District Attorney, and that the District Attorney had authorized release of at least some of the requested material. He asked the County to provide the records that were authorized for release.

Judy Ahrens, Josephine County resident, spoke about remembrance of September 11, civic and history education, and academic performance in Oregon. She encouraged attendance at the Three Rivers School District meeting that evening and expressed support for traditional academic instruction and patriotic education.

7. BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:

Commissioner Richardson stated that he had seen a District Attorney document indicating that at least some of Mr. Fitch's requested material appeared releasable and said he would look into why it had not yet been provided. Responding to Ms. Ahrens, he said Grants Pass School District 7 had recognized September 11 and would hold Constitution Day activities, and he discussed local reading performance and differences among states' graduation requirements.

Commissioner Martin said the County had experienced issues with public-information requests but that those processes should now be improved, and that releasable information should be provided in a timely manner. She also described a recent school-board presentation concerning September 11 and thanked the Constitution Week visitors for their work in the community.

Chair Smith said he would speak with Legal Counsel regarding Mr. Fitch's records request. He also thanked the visiting Constitution Week representatives and commented on the importance of the Constitution and the Bill of Rights.

8. APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:

a. Minutes (draft minutes are available for viewing in the Board's Office)

Admin Workshop - September 8, 2026

Weekly Business Session - September 9, 2026

Board Journal - August 2026

Commissioner Richardson motion was made to approve the Consent Calendar as presented. Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

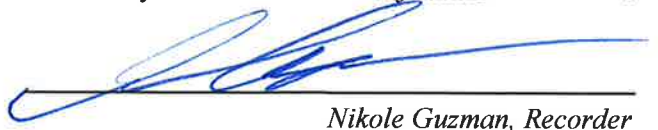
9. OTHER MATTERS: *(ORS 192.640(1) ...Commissioners may introduce other matters for consideration by the entire board)*

None heard.

10. ANNOUNCEMENTS: *(Commissioners may discuss any topic of interest to the general community)*

Commissioners Richardson and Martin reported no announcements. Chair Smith reminded the public that Josephine County was not yet out of fire season, noted the County had avoided a major catastrophic fire during the season, and thanked professional firefighters for their work.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:17 a.m.



Nikole Guzman, Recorder